

The Glassblower

A lunge forward. Front leg bent and bearing the weight of his body. The back leg stretched out behind, heel pointing skyward, calf bunched up, a line of sweat through his shorts. Lips pursed on the end of the metal rod, the expanding breath of inhalation, the narrow jet of exhalation. The glass, molten and glowing the dusk trees to day, blooms. First in a viscous knob, then the air from the breath, a wide growing exploration of a nebula. He spins the rod with the tips of his fingers, the glass thrown out forming the base of a gourd.

The glassblower removes his lips from the rod and takes more of the cool morning air. His lips again to the metal, expanding a second lobe, spinning all the while. The outer shell hardens and he clips the gourd free, his breath forever entombed between the shades of green, violet, blue.